County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, June 8, 2026
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/390291**

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:00 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Council Member Dawson led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the agenda.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Reitz to amend the agenda to move item 13.c and make it 13.a.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover,

Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion to amend passed 11:0.

Main Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the agenda as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The amended motion passed 11:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve the minutes from Caucus and County Council May 26, 2026 and Special Called County Council Meeting June 1, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

6. Proclamation

a. Proclamation recognizing June as Forging Strong Fathers and Families Month

Council Member Lawson presented a proclamation to the South Carolina Center for Fathers and Families recognizing June as Forging Strong Fathers and Families Month.

b. Proclamation recognizing June as Trails Month.

Chair Howard presented a proclamation to Friends of the Spanish Moss Trail recognizing June as Trails Month.

c. Proclamation recognizing July 25 - August 1 as Gullah/Geechee Nation Appreciation Week.

Council Member Glover presented a proclamation to Queen Quet recognizing July 25-August 1 as Gullah/Geechee Nation Appreciation Week.

7. Administrators Report

Michael Moore, County Administrator, presented longevity awards to county employees. Please watch the video stream on the county website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/390291

8. Public Comment Period

Public comments were made. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/390291**

9. Liaison and Committee Reports

No reports were given.

10. Agenda Items

a. Business License Appeal to Council: St. Francis Center, Inc.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Dawson to exempt the St. Francis Center from needing to get a business license and also allow them to get a sign without a sign permit.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

11. Resolutions

a. 2026/22: A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute the documents necessary and to provide funds to contribute to the procurement by the applicant, the Town of Hilton Head Island, for the acquisition of fee simple real property located on Hilton Head Island, known as the Broad Creek Marina Tract (PIN# R510 011 000 0006 0000), not to exceed the requested amount ($7,700,000).

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Lawson, Seconded by Council Member Cunningham to push this item back to Greenspace for them to gather all the due diligence information and bring it back to the next County Council meeting to present it again.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

b. 2026/23: A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute the documents necessary and to provide funds for the procurement by the applicant, The Nature Conservancy, for the acquisition of fee simple real property located in the Town of Bluffton, known as the New River Forest (Portion of PIN#'s R614 045 000 0019 0000, R610 044 000 0126 0000), not to exceed the requested amount ($42,000,000).

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Reitz to postpone the vote to next County Council meeting to give time for people of Palmetto Bluff to come make public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 6:5.

12. Ordinances for Third Reading

a. 2026/26: An Ordinance amending Chapter 38 Environment, Article VI Single Use Plastic Bags; Article VI Section 38-161 Purpose and Intent; Section 38-162 Definitions; Section 38-163 Regulations; Section 38-164 Exemptions; and Section 38-166 Effective Date and Review of the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on April 6, 2026 - 5:2
The vote at First Reading on May 11, 2026 - 6:5
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on May 26, 2026 - 7:3

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Dawson, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve Third Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/26.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member

Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 7:4.

13. Ordinances for Second Reading

a. 2026/27: An Ordinance to provide for the levy of tax for school purposes for Beaufort County for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2026, and ending June 30, 2027, and to make appropriations for said purposes.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on May 18, 2026 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/27.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

b. 2026/28: An Ordinance amending Beaufort County Ordinance Chapter 102 Waterways. Article 1, sections 102–1 definitions, Article II, division 1, section 102-27, purpose, section 102-28, penalties, section 102-29, general prohibitions, section 102-30, dock rules, section 102-31, landing rules, division II, section 102-61, description, division 3, section 102-95, description, section 102-98, penalties, section 102-99 general prohibitions, section 102-100, dock rules, section 102-101, landing rules, Article III, section 102-133, definitions, section 102-134, penalties, section 102-136, student riders, section 102-137, public ridership. **PUBLIC HEARING**

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on May 18, 2026 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/28.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

Public comments were made.

Vice Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Passiment to amend the Ordinance by removing Section C in Section 102-136.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion to amend passed 11:0.

Main Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/28 as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council

Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The amended motion passed 11:0.

c. 2026/29: An Ordinance to make appropriations for County Government and Special Purpose Districts for Beaufort County for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2026, and ending June 30, 2027; to levy taxes for the payment thereof; to adopt service and user fees; to provide for the expenditure of said taxes and other revenues coming into the county; and other matters related thereto.
PUBLIC HEARING

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on May 18, 2026 - 7:1
The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 9:1

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/29.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to allocate $12,000 for Tri share and that would give us 3 slots at the Children's Center from unincorporated Beaufort and if it gets matching funds, it will take us to 6 slots. The funding would come from the vehicle line item.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard and Council Member Dawson. The motion to amend passed 9:2.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Reitz to reinstate the budget for the Department of Health and Human Services for FY27 in the amount of $465,000, which would thereby reverse the Administration's decision to close the department effective June 30, 2026, and the funds would come from Capital Improvement Projects.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, and Council Member McElynn. The motion to amend passed 8:3.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Reitz to remove the 2 positions funded at the last meeting for the Treasurer's office and fully fund the original budget submitted to County Council, and the funds would come from Capital Improvement Projects.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, and Council Member Lawson. The motion to amend passed 6:5.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

Public comments were made.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to fund $6,000 to the Auditor's overtime budget from the vehicle line item.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion to amend passed 11:0.

Main Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/29 as amended four times.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Vice-Chair Tabernik. The amended motion passed 10:1.

d. 2026/33: An Ordinance Amending the Community Development Code (CDC): Division 5.10 (Historic Preservation), Section 7.2.120 (Certificate Of Appropriateness), Section 7.3.80 (Historic Designation), Section 7.4.50 (Public Hearing Scheduling and Notice), and Section 7.5.40 (Historic Preservation Review Board (Hprb)).

   The vote at Natural Resources Committee on May 4, 2026 - 6:0
   The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 9:1

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to postpone Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/33 until the next County Council meeting on June 22, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

e. 2026/32: An Ordinance Amending the Community Development Code (CDC): Table 3.1.60 (Consolidated Use Table), Table 3.2.40. H (T2R Allowed Uses), and Division 4.1 (Specific to Use).

   The vote at Natural Resources Committee on May 4, 2026 - 6:0
   The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/32 for the following reasons: it is consistent with the goals, objectives, and policies of the Comprehensive Plan; it is not in conflict with any provision of this Development Code or the Code of Ordinances; it is required by changed conditions; it does address a demonstrated community need; it is consistent with the purposes and intent of the zones in this Development Code, or would improve compatibility among uses and ensure efficient development within the County; it would result in a logical and orderly development pattern; and it would not result in adverse impacts on the natural environment including but not limited to water, air, noise, stormwater management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover,

Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

f. 2026/30: An Ordinance Providing for a 2026 Transportation Sales Tax Referendum.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on May 18, 2026 - 5:2
The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/30.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Chair Howard to take version 2 of the Ordinance which specifies the projects in the intersection and safety, widening, and resurfacing of the dirt roads, along with question #2, which will approve the issuance of bonds not exceeding $450,000,000.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion to amend passed 11:0.

Main Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/30 as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, and Council Member Reitz. The amended motion passed 8:3.

g. 2026/35: An Ordinance authorizing the acceptance of Drainage Easements Associated with Drainage Systems in the Bay Pines Subdivision.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on May 18, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Reitz to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/35.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

h. 2026/36: An Ordinance Authorizing a Lease Agreement between Beaufort County and the General Services Administration (GSA) for Transportation Security Administration (TSA) use within the Hilton Head Island Airport terminal.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on May 18, 2026 - 6:0
The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/36.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council

Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

i. 2026/31: An Ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Parks and Recreation Ordinance (Ordinance NO. 2018/41 Sec. 90-33) to change the Parks and Recreations Board's authority to set fees and rates.

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on May 4, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/31.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

14. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

Alice G. Howard

BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:

Sarah W. B

_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: June 22, 2026